A 2D PIXEL-ART PLATFORMER

# PONCHO

## Siete Vidas



A cat has nine lives. In Spanish, a cat has seven.
You are going to spend all of them.

Web and mobile browsers | Pitch v1

THE HOOK

# Seven lives. Every one visible.

## Nine lives in English. Siete vidas in Spanish.

- The title is the mechanic: Poncho starts every world with seven lives, drawn as seven triangles, the motif of his poncho.
- A lost life cracks and fades to an outline. You always see exactly how much room for error is left.
- Lives are scarce on purpose. Ofrendas (Día de Muertos altars) are checkpoints that give one back; a hidden veladora (candle) gives one more. Nothing else does.
- Last life left: the music turns tense and hilos (collectible threads) score double. Risk and reward, never an extra penalty.



**4 of 7 left**

THE HERO

# Meet Poncho

- A chubby chibi cat in a blue sombrero and a serape with red and cream triangles, holding a taco.
- Loves tacos and spicy food. That is also the power-up system: a taco shields a hit, a chile unlocks fire.
- Origin character of Poncho on Base ("PB"), the cutest cat on Base. The game stands alone: offline, no wallet, no token, no account.
- Tone: warm, playful, a little spooky. Specific, respectful Mexican references (serape, talavera, papel picado, alebrijes, ofrendas), never a caricature.



GAMEPLAY

# Cat agility: it has to feel right

## Quick and light

Run 120 px/s, snappy turn-around, generous air control.

## Variable jump

Tap for a 15 px hop, hold for 56 px (3.5 tiles). A floaty apex hang at the peak.

## Forgiving

100 ms coyote time, 100 ms jump buffer, corner correction at block edges.

## Always lands on its feet

No fall damage. Respawn is a flip that ends feet-first.

Fixed 60 Hz deterministic simulation, unit-tested against the numbers in the design doc, so tuning is exact and replayable.

STRUCTURE

# Seven worlds, one for every life

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Desierto** | Chihuahuan desert village, adobe, agave | Tutorial world, sand slopes |
| 2 | **Mercado** | Market rooftops, awnings and stalls | Bouncy awnings, papel picado |
| 3 | **Sierra** | Sierra Madre cliffs and old mines | Moving carts, crumbling ledges |
| 4 | **Selva** | Rain forest and ruins | Vines, water, updrafts |
| 5 | **Cenote** | Flooded caverns of the Yucatán | Water, darkness and light spots |
| 6 | **Volcán** | Volcano and lava fields | Rising lava, timed platforms |
| 7 | **Mictlán** | Día de Muertos finale, marigold paths | All mechanics, final boss |

Each world: 3 levels and a boss. 28 stages in the full game. World 1 boss: Don Zopilote, a giant vulture. Names and themes are a starting point.

WHERE WE ARE

# Playable today



In-game sandbox, placeholder art

## Built and tested

- Run, jump, forgiveness windows
- Tile collision, pits, level edges
- Seven-life HUD with crack animation
- Respawn flip, ofrenda checkpoints
- Spikes, crumbling tiles, springs
- Moving platforms, doors and keys
- Taco power-up and pinata blocks
- Touch buttons and a slide stick

**Not yet: real art and music, enemies, bosses, claw, fire, menus and saves. Art and audio are placeholders.**

ROADMAP

# The road to a vertical slice

## Now

Core movement, lives and hazards are playable in a sandbox level. Gate, unit tests and playtests run on every change.

## Next: vertical slice

Stomp and claw, chile and fire, World 1 with 3 levels, Don Zopilote, keyboard and touch, autosave, pause, volume and language.

## Later

Worlds 2 to 7, glide and wall cling, Chile Fantasma, cosmetics for hilos, full soundtrack, more languages.

Built on Phaser 4, TypeScript, Vite and Vitest. Pixel art at 480x270, scaled cleanly to any screen, installable offline as a PWA.



# Seven lives.
# Spend them well.

A charming, precise, fair platformer about a cat who loves tacos, wears a serape, and always lands on their feet.